

Security and Risk Management Module Reflection

I started the Security and Risk Management module in January with some apprehension. I knew from the beginning that it would be a very general module, with a lot of reading and not much technical content. As someone more interested in practical and technical areas of cybersecurity, especially forensic work, I was not very confident that I would enjoy it or feel fully engaged with it. I also expected it to be one of the most difficult modules for me to stay motivated in.

However, as the module progressed, I realised that my first impression was too limited. Even if the module was not technical in the way I usually prefer, I still learned a lot. In particular, I developed a better understanding of the Security and Risk Management process and of the value of structured frameworks such as ISO 31000 and ISO/IEC 27005. Before this module, I mainly associated cybersecurity with technical controls, attacks, and investigations. This module helped me understand that security is also about identifying, analysing, and managing risks in a structured way.

One of the main things I learned is that security is not only technical. It is also linked to business continuity, decision-making, compliance, human factors, and organisational priorities. This changed the way I see cybersecurity. Even if I do not want to work in governance, this module was still useful for me because it gave me a broader understanding of how organisations manage security issues. As a future cybersecurity professional, I think this knowledge will still help me because technical

work does not happen in isolation. It is always linked to business needs and risk-based decisions.

The group work also helped me develop useful skills. Through the status document and the final project, I contributed to research, written work, and group discussions. I had to work with others, organise ideas, compare information from different sources, and apply academic and professional frameworks. This helped me improve my collaboration skills and also my ability to present ideas in a more structured way.

At the beginning of the module, I lacked confidence in the group project because the other team members seemed to have a stronger cybersecurity background than me. Because of that, I was sometimes too quiet and hesitant to share my ideas.

However, this group project helped me realise that I was still able to contribute in meaningful ways, especially through research, written analysis, and structured thinking. This experience increased my confidence and changed the way I see my role in a team. In future group work, I would like to contribute more actively, speak more, and share my point of view more openly.

Looking back, one area where I could have done better is seminar participation. I think I should have been more involved in some seminar activities. At the time, I sometimes underestimated their value, maybe because I was more focused on finishing the work than on engaging in discussion. In hindsight, the seminars were actually very helpful because they clarified expectations, helped connect theory to practice, and supported my understanding of the assessments.

Another point I reflected on is that I did not ask enough questions when I was unsure. At times, I kept my doubts to myself instead of engaging more with the teacher or my peers. Looking back, this limited my learning because asking

questions could have helped me clarify concepts earlier and participate more actively in discussions. In the future, I want to be more proactive, ask for clarification when needed, and engage more confidently with both tutors and classmates.

Another important part of my learning was seeing the difference between the Unit 6 status document and the Unit 11 final project. This helped me see my progress during the module. In Unit 6, my understanding of Security and Risk Management was still quite general and more descriptive. I was still trying to understand how to use the frameworks properly and how to link theory to the case study in a clear way. By Unit 11, I felt more comfortable with the frameworks and more confident in choosing relevant ideas and presenting them more clearly. I think this showed a real improvement in both my writing and my understanding of risk. It also showed me that my learning developed step by step during the module.

This module also supported my personal and professional development. It pushed me to work on concepts that I would not naturally choose first, and this helped me become more open-minded and more well-rounded. It also improved my academic skills, especially in analysing sources, applying frameworks, and presenting arguments in a clearer and more structured way. Although I still prefer more technical modules, I now see Security and Risk Management as an important foundation and not as something separate from technical cybersecurity.

Overall, this module changed my perspective. I started it thinking it would be too general and not very relevant to my interests. By the end, I understood that risk management is an important part of cybersecurity and that it supports technical practice rather than replacing it. If I were to do this module again, I would be more active in seminars, ask more questions when I am unsure, and contribute more

confidently to team discussions. The main lesson I take from this module is that useful learning does not always come from the most technical content, but also from understanding the wider context in which security work takes place.